

Which Organizer, When?

Unit 6 · World War II (1939–1945) · US.45–US.58

Match the task to the tool — then
teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

45-minute class? Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...	REACH FOR	≈ TIME	BECAUSE IT WORKS
Compare two things	● Venn diagram · T-chart	10–15 MIN	The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>
Compare three or more on set criteria	● Comparison matrix	15–20 MIN	Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.
Trace causes & effects	● Cause & Effect	15–20 MIN	Makes the chain of “why it happened” visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Put events in order / show change over time	● Timeline	15–20 MIN	Sequence exposes cause across time. <i>Builds SSP.05 chronology.</i>
Brainstorm & connect ideas	● Concept web	10–15 MIN	Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.
Summarize — find the main point	● Main Idea & Details	10–15 MIN	Separates the big idea from the details that support it.
Activate prior knowledge & track learning	● K-W-L chart	10–15 MIN	Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>
Learn a key term	● Frayer model	10–15 MIN	Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.
Analyze a source	● HIPPO (or OPTIC)	15–20 MIN	Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.
Make an evidence-based claim	● C-E-R	20–25 MIN	Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.
Weigh two sides or options	● T-chart · Problem-Solution	15–20 MIN	Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.
Get the basics of an event	● 5 Ws	5–10 MIN	Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.
Connect the nation to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	10–15 MIN	Local ties make national history stick — and it's what sets History Hack apart. Our signature move.

SSP Crosswalk

✓ REPRODUCIBLE

Which organizer builds which practice — and where it lives in Unit 6

Every organizer in this toolkit is also a **skills tool**. Use this crosswalk to name the Tennessee Social Studies Practice you're building — and to pick the organizer that builds it best.

PRACTICE	WHAT STUDENTS DO	BUILD IT WITH	USE IT WHEN · WHERE IN UNIT 6
SSP.01 Collect Information	Gather facts from primary & secondary sources.	5 Ws Main Idea & Details K-W-L	Intake: pulling the who/what/when and key ideas out of a reading, image, or lecture.
SSP.02 Critically Examine Sources	Interrogate a source: author, audience, point of view, purpose, reliability.	HIPPO C-E-R	Any primary source in US.45–US.58 — a Pearl Harbor headline, camp-liberation footage, or an internment order.
SSP.03 Synthesize Data	Organize & combine data from several sources into one picture.	Comparison matrix Concept web Main Idea	US.45 (fascism vs. communism) & US.50 (the major battles) — holding many cases against one yardstick.
SSP.04 Construct & Communicate with Evidence	Build and defend an argument or explanation with evidence.	C-E-R T-chart Problem–Solution	US.54 (internment — security vs. the Constitution) & US.56 (the atomic-bomb decision) — take a stance.
SSP.05 Develop Historical Awareness	Sequence in time, trace cause & effect, and see change over time.	Timeline Cause & Effect Concept web	US.46 (FDR's steps toward war) & US.48 (the road to Pearl Harbor → U.S. entry).
SSP.06 Develop Geographic Awareness	Read place, region & spatial patterns; connect geography to events.	Battle map ★ Tennessee Connection	US.50 (Pacific & European battle geography) — and every Tennessee Connection (Oak Ridge, Fort Campbell).

Venn Diagram — Compare Two

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Compare 2 Things

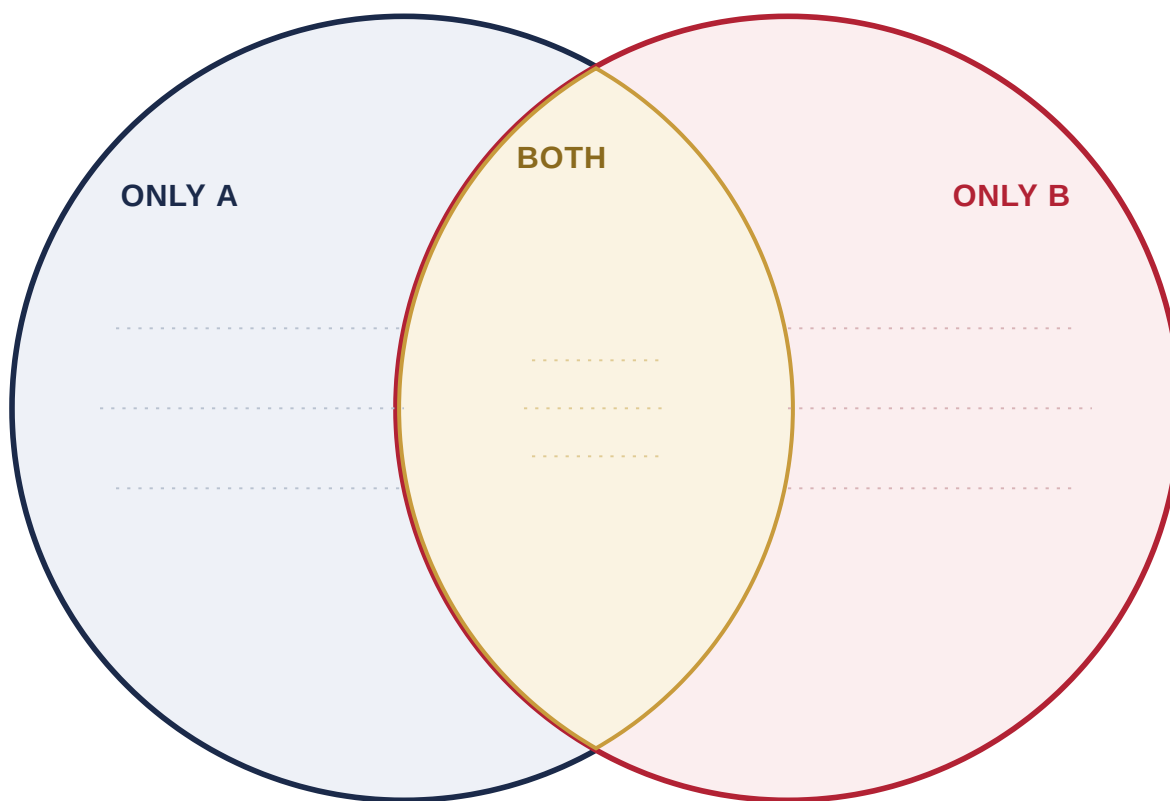
DOK 2 • Comparison

WHEN • WHY Use when a task asks students to **compare two** things — the overlap makes shared traits visible and forces precise differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

In each circle, write what is unique to that topic. In the middle, write what they share.

Topic A: _____

Topic B: _____



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank and a sentence starter: "Both ____ and ____ are ____." Let pairs fill the BOTH region first.

EXTEND

Rank the differences: which one matters most, and why? Defend it in one sentence of evidence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the circles with sticky notes.

Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

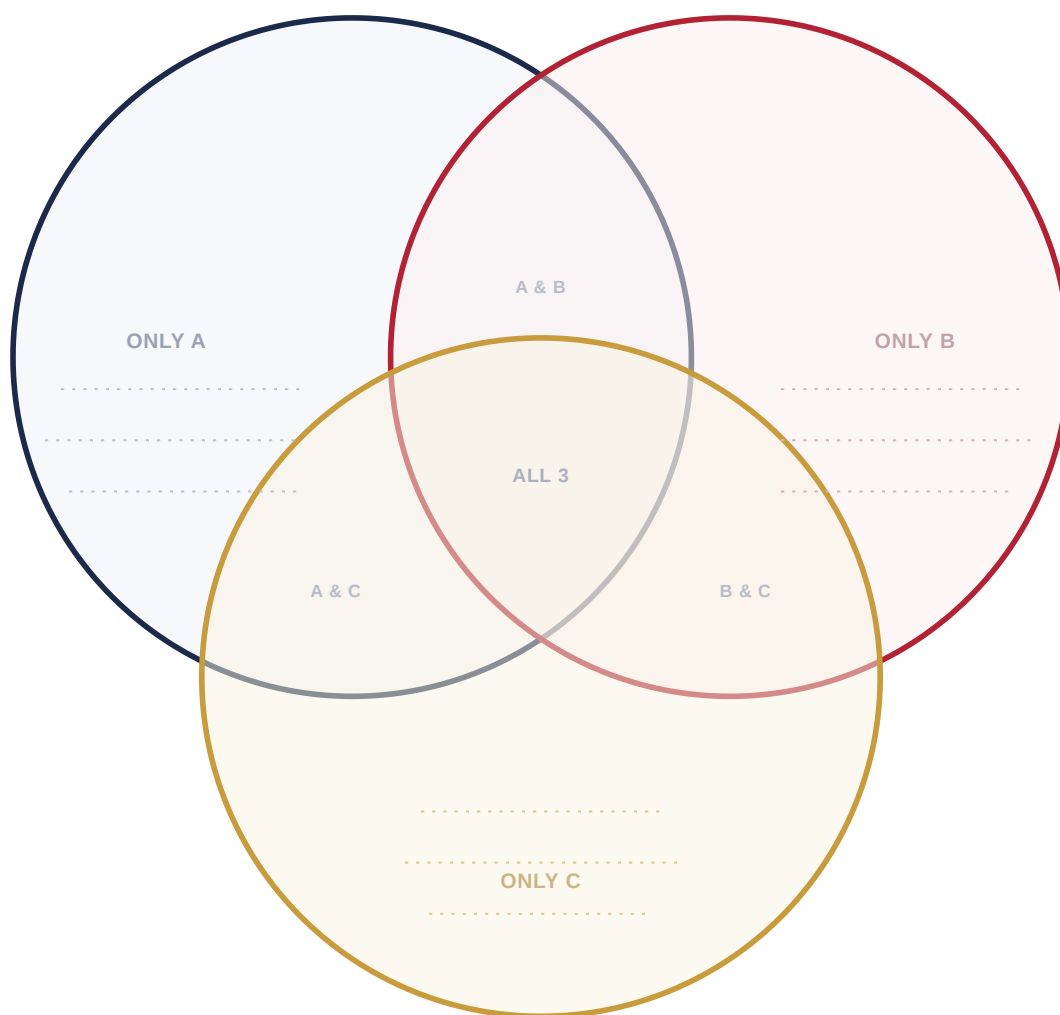
Compare 3

DOK 2-3 • Comparison

WHEN • WHY Use when a task asks students to **compare three** things at once — the overlaps expose what is shared by two, what is shared by all three, and what stays unique. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

Name each topic in the key, then fill the circles: unique traits in the single lobes, shared traits where they overlap.

○ Topic A: _____ ○ Topic B: _____ ○ Topic C: _____



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SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank and start with the ALL 3 center: "All three share ____." Let pairs fill one lobe at a time.

EXTEND

Argue which topic is the "odd one out" and defend it with one trait from its unique lobe.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the circles with sticky notes.

🕒 10-15 min

Compare 2

WHEN · WHY Use to compare **two** things head-to-head on points you choose, lining up each trait side-by-side so real differences stand out. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

[illegible]

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the two columns with sticky notes.

WHEN · WHY Use to compare **three or more** things across several named criteria at once, so patterns across the whole set become visible. *Comparing on structured criteria — identifying similarities & differences — is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

Name each option across the top and each criterion down the side. Fill every box with what that option shows for that criterion. Then name the pattern you see.

CRITERIA ↓ OPTIONS →	Option A	Option B	Option C
CRITERION 1			
CRITERION 2			
CRITERION 3			

Pattern · conclusion — what the whole matrix tells you

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Pre-name one or two criteria and a starter:
“On ___, Option A ___ while Option C ___.” Complete one row as a class.

EXTEND
In the conclusion, explain *why* the pattern holds — what causes options to line up or split the way they do?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** symbols in cells, or **build** the grid with cards.

Cause & Effect

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Causes / Effects

SSP.05 · DOK 2–3

WHEN · WHY Use when a task asks **what led to** an event and **what followed** from it — separating causes from effects builds reasoning about change over time. *Analyzing cause & effect is a core TN Social Studies Practice (SSP.05).*

List what led to the event on the left, then what followed from it on the right. Arrows show the flow: causes → event → effects.

CAUSES · WHAT LED TO IT	THE EVENT	EFFECTS · WHAT FOLLOWED
Cause 1	EVENT / TOPIC NAME THE EVENT OR DECISION	Effect 1
Cause 2		Effect 2
Cause 3		Effect 3

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SCAFFOLD

Offer sentence frames: “Because ____, the event happened,” and “As a result, ____.” Fill the event box first.

EXTEND

Rank the causes from most to least important, or trace one effect into a new cause (a chain).

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** arrows/icons, or **build** it with cards.

Timeline — Order & Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Order / sequence

SSP.05 • Chronology

WHEN • WHY Use to put events in **order** and see how things **change over time** — the vertical spine makes sequence and distance between events visible. *Chronological reasoning — ordering events and tracking change — is a core practice (TN Social Studies Practices SSP.05).*

Order the events from earliest (top) to latest (bottom). On each line, write the date on the left, then what happened on the right.

▲ EARLIEST

ORDER • CHANGE OVER TIME

DATE / WHEN	1	WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS
DATE / WHEN	2	WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS
DATE / WHEN	3	WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS
DATE / WHEN	4	WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS
DATE / WHEN	5	WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

▼ LATEST / MOST RECENT

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SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards and have students **physically sequence** them before writing. Sentence starter: "First ____, then ____, and finally ____."

EXTEND

Mark the moment of biggest **change**. Explain in one sentence what caused it and what it changed.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** dates, **say** the sequence aloud, **draw** an icon per event, or **build** the line with cards.

Concept Web

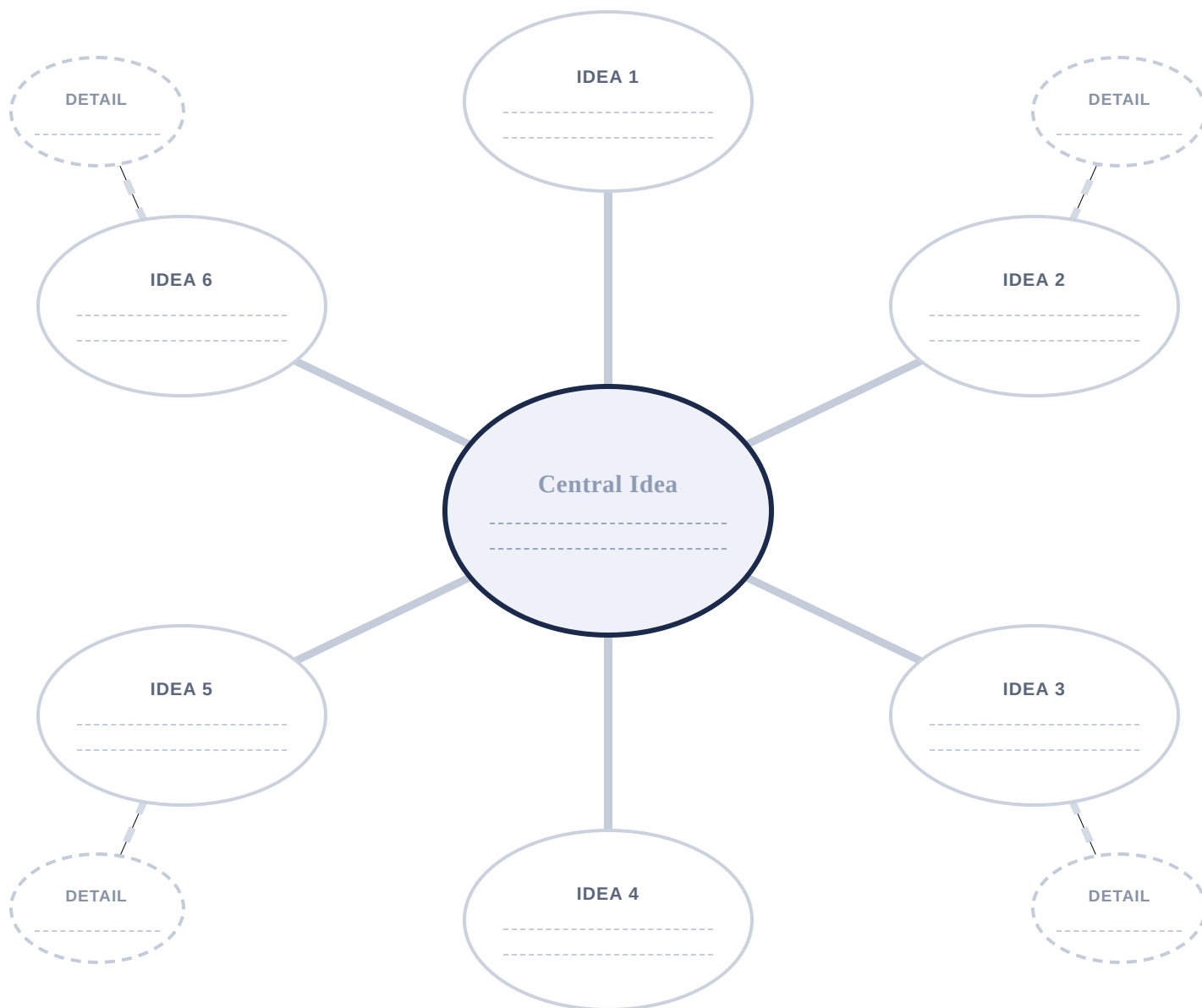
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Brainstorm / connect

DOK 2 • Relationships

WHEN • WHY Use to **brainstorm** around a central concept and show how ideas branch and **connect** to it. The hub-and-spoke shape makes relationships between ideas visible at a glance. *Organizing ideas into a nonlinear web supports schema-building (UDL 3.0).*

Write the big idea in the center. On each outer bubble, add an idea that connects to it — then use the small bubbles for a supporting detail.



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SCAFFOLD

Seed two bubbles for students and give a linking stem: "This connects to the center because ____."

EXTEND

Draw new lines **between** outer bubbles that relate to each other and label what the link is.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons in bubbles, or **build** it with sticky notes.

Main Idea & Details

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Summarize

DOK 2 · Main Idea

WHEN · WHY Use to pull the **central point** out of a text or lecture and anchor it to the details and evidence that support it.
Summarizing — keeping the main idea and cutting the rest — is a high-yield comprehension strategy (Marzano).

Write the main idea at the top. In each box below, add a detail or piece of evidence that supports it — the arrows show every detail holding the main idea up. Then say it all in one sentence.

MAIN IDEA

↑ THESE DETAILS SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA ↑

Detail 1

Detail 2

Detail 3

Detail 4

Summary — the whole thing in one sentence

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UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Give a main-idea frame: "This is mostly about ____ because ____." Fill one detail box together before students work.

EXTEND
Rank the details from strongest to weakest support, or add a detail that would *weaken* the main idea.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** an icon per detail, or **build** it with labeled cards.

🕒 10-15 min)

Activate + track

DOK 1–2 · Metacognition

TOPIC _____

[illegible]

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Fill **K** as a whole class on chart paper first.
Give question stems for **W**: "I wonder ____"
/ "How does ____?"

In **L**, mark which of your **W** questions got answered — and write one new question you still have.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **draw** what they know and learned in each column.

5 Ws — Who • What • When • Where • Why

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY Use to quickly capture the **essential facts** of an event — who, what, when, where, and why (plus how). The hub-and-spoke keeps every key question in view at once. *Establishing the who/what/when/where anchors chronological reasoning (TN Social Studies Practices).*

Name the event in the center, then answer each spoke to capture the essential facts. (Use How to stretch to six.)

WHO • PEOPLE

WHAT • HAPPENED

WHEN • TIME

WHERE • PLACE

WHY • REASON

HOW • THE WAY

EVENT / TOPIC • NAME IT HERE

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SCAFFOLD

Provide sentence stems for each spoke:
 “This happened because ____,” “It took place in ____.”

EXTEND

Turn the six facts into a one-sentence summary, or rank which W matters most for understanding the event.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** the spokes with cards.

WHEN · WHY Use to define a **problem**, weigh two or three possible solutions against their likely results, and justify the best choice with evidence. *Generating & testing possible solutions is a high-yield reasoning strategy (Marzano); it builds cause-effect thinking (TN SSP.05).*

State the problem, map 2–3 possible solutions with their likely results, then choose the best one and justify it. Follow the arrows: problem → options → decision.

PROBLEM — what is wrong, and for whom?

WEIGH THE OPTIONS

Possible Solution 1	Possible Solution 2	Possible Solution 3
Likely result · trade-off	Likely result · trade-off	Likely result · trade-off

DECIDE

Best solution + justification — I chose ____ because...

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Provide the problem and one solution; students supply the rest. Offer a starter: "If we ____, then ____ because ____."

EXTEND
Add a second criterion (cost *and* fairness) and explain a trade-off you are willing to accept.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** the flow, or **build** the options with cards and vote.

🕒 10-15 min

Learn a term

WHEN · WHY Use to build **deep word knowledge** — not just a definition, but traits, examples, and non-examples that sharpen the boundary of a concept. *Contrasting examples with non-examples strengthens concept learning (Marzano — similarities & differences).*

2. CHARACTERISTICS / FACTS

[illegible]

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** an icon for each example, or **build** the quadrants with sticky notes.

Claim • Evidence • Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Make a claim

DOK 3 • Argument

WHEN • WHY Use to build an **evidence-based argument** — a defensible claim, the evidence that supports it, and the reasoning that ties them together. *Constructing arguments from evidence is a core disciplinary practice (TN Social Studies Practices).*

State your claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning — how the evidence proves the claim.

CLAIM — my answer to the question

BACKED BY



EVIDENCE — facts, quotes & details that prove it

1

2

3

WHICH PROVES



REASONING — this evidence supports my claim because...

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SCAFFOLD

Give a claim frame: “___ because ___.” and a reasoning starter: “This shows ___ because ___.” Fill just one evidence box first.

EXTEND

Add a **counterclaim** and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record) the argument, or **build** it from evidence cards before writing.

HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Analyze a source

DOK 3 • Sourcing

WHEN • WHY Use to **interrogate a primary source** so students read like historians — questioning context, audience, point of view, and purpose instead of taking it at face value. *Sourcing and contextualizing evidence is a core disciplinary practice (TN Social Studies Practices).*

Cite the source, then interrogate it — read it like a historian, one H-I-P-P-O question at a time.

SOURCE — title / author / date

H

HISTORICAL CONTEXT *What was happening at the time?*

I

INTENDED AUDIENCE *Who was it made for?*

P

POINT OF VIEW *Who made it — what is their bias / perspective?*

P

PURPOSE *Why was it made? What did they want?*

O

OUTSIDE INFORMATION *What do you already know that connects?*

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SCAFFOLD

Model one letter aloud with the class first. Provide a question stem per box and let partners discuss before writing.

EXTEND

Rank the five letters: which one most changes how you should **trust** this source, and why?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write, say** (record) their analysis, or **annotate** the source directly.

Tennessee Connection

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Local ↔ National

DOK 3 • Connect

WHEN • WHY History sticks when it comes home. This organizer links a national event to a Tennessee person, place, or law — then asks students to argue why the local story matters. *Relevance and personal connection drive engagement and retention (UDL 3.0).*

Zoom in: link the national story to Tennessee — then say why the local story matters.

National topic / standard: _____

THE NATIONAL STORY

WHAT HAPPENED ACROSS THE U.S.?

THE TENNESSEE STORY

A TN PERSON, PLACE, OR LAW



THE LINK — how does the Tennessee story connect to the national one?

WHY THE LOCAL STORY MATTERS — why should Tennesseans know this?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide the TN name/place and one national fact; students write only the *link* sentence: "This connects because ____."

EXTEND

Argue whether the Tennessee example is typical of the nation or an exception — and what that tells us.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** the link aloud, **draw** a map line from TN to the nation, or **build** it as a matching pair.

WHEN · WHY A matrix holds fascism, communism, and totalitarianism against one yardstick, so their ideas, economics, and power structures compare clearly — and the overlap becomes visible. *Comparing on structured criteria is Marzano’s highest-yield strategy; SSP.03 synthesize.*

Compare the three systems across the same four questions. The faint notes are starters — write over them, then find where fascism and communism differ but both turn totalitarian.

SYSTEM → CRITERIA ↓	Fascism Italy & Germany	Communism Soviet Union	Totalitarianism the shared system
Core idea	<i>ultranationalism — the nation above the individual; militarism</i>	<i>class struggle; workers overthrow capitalism → a classless society</i>	<i>the state controls all of public & private life</i>
The economy	<i>corporate state — private owners, but the government directs it</i>	<i>collective & state ownership; central planning</i>	<i>government direction of the economy</i>
Who holds power	<i>one leader (Führer/Duce); cult of personality</i>	<i>a vanguard Communist Party rules for the workers</i>	<i>a dictator + secret police, propaganda, no dissent</i>
Where seen	<i>Mussolini’s Italy; Hitler’s Germany</i>	<i>Stalin’s Soviet Union</i>	<i>Nazi Germany, the USSR & Fascist Italy alike</i>

Your call: Fascism and communism were bitter enemies — so how did both become **totalitarian**? _____

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SCAFFOLD
Fill the **Core idea** row together first as the model, then let students complete the rest by column.

EXTEND
Fascism and communism opposed each other — yet both produced dictatorships. Explain that paradox using the “who holds power” row.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write** in cells, **say** a column aloud, or **chart** the three systems side by side.

From Neutral to the Arsenal of Democracy

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY A timeline makes the **sequence** visible — each step moves the U.S. a little further from isolationism toward aiding the Allies, well before Pearl Harbor. *Chronological reasoning — ordering events and tracking change — is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

Read the five steps from earliest (top) to latest (bottom). The date is on the left, the event on the right — write over the faint notes, then mark where America shifts from staying out to helping the Allies.

▲ EARLIEST • ISOLATIONISM

FDR MOVES THE U.S. TOWARD INVOLVEMENT



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the five events on cards; have students **sequence** them before writing. Ask: which one was the biggest step toward war?

EXTEND

Between which two steps did America change the most? Explain what caused the shift.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** the events, **say** the sequence aloud, or **build** the line with cards.

The U.S. Response to the Holocaust

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Main Idea & Details

DOK 2-3 · Analyze

WHEN · WHY A main-idea organizer separates the **big idea** from the details that support it, so students can analyze a difficult history with care across its three phases. *Summarizing and analyzing evidence are high-yield practices (SSP.01, SSP.02).*

Fill each detail box first, using the faint hints as anchors. Then infer the main idea all four support and write it up top — the arrows show every detail holding it up. Finish with one summary sentence.

MAIN IDEA

The U.S. response to the Holocaust was limited before the war, direct in liberating the camps, and opened afterward to survivors.

↑ THESE FOUR POINTS SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA ↑

Before the War	Why Doors Stayed Closed	Liberating the Camps	After the War
1924 quota law limited Jewish immigration; the St. Louis turned away (937 refugees, 1939); Evian Conference (1938) failed.	Anti-Semitism, isolationism, Depression-era economic fears, and security concerns; the War Refugee Board came only in 1944.	U.S. forces freed Buchenwald, Dachau & Mauthausen; soldiers documented the atrocities; footage shocked the public and aided the Nuremberg trials.	The Displaced Persons Act (1948) admitted about 205,000 people; survivors resettled in the U.S.

In one sentence, how would you describe the U.S. response to the Holocaust?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Fill the four boxes first using the faint hints, then infer the main idea together. Frame: “Across all three phases, the U.S. response was ____.”

EXTEND
Historians debate whether the U.S. could have done more before 1944. Use the first two boxes to weigh that question with evidence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write** the boxes, **say** the main idea aloud, or present it as a short **timeline**.

Why America Went to War

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY Reading it as **pressures** → **Pearl Harbor** → **entry** shows that war came from both theaters — and that one attack turned a divided nation into a united one. *Analyzing cause & effect is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

Pressures in two theaters plus one attack sit on the left; four effects flow out on the right. Arrows show the chain: pressures → Pearl Harbor → U.S. entry.

CAUSES • THE ROAD TO WAR

Europe: German U-boats attack U.S. ships; Destroyer Deal; an undeclared naval war

Pacific: Japan expands; U.S. oil embargo & frozen assets (July 1941); talks fail

The spark: Pearl Harbor (Dec. 7, 1941) — 8 battleships hit; 2,403 killed

THE EVENT

THE U.S. ENTERS WWII, 1941

Pearl Harbor ended the debate over neutrality — describe why the U.S. went to war

EFFECTS • A NATION AT WAR

U.S. declares war on Japan (Dec. 8, 1941)

Germany & Italy declare war on the U.S. — America is in both theaters

Massive mobilization; the “Europe First” strategy

Isolationism ends — the nation unites behind the war

★ **Tennessee Connection.** After Pearl Harbor, Tennesseans enlisted in massive numbers, continuing the “**Volunteer State**” tradition. Congressman **Albert Gore Sr.** of Carthage voted for the declaration of war and later served in the Army as the state’s industry converted to war production.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Sort the causes into **Europe**, **Pacific**, and **the spark**. Fill the center box first.

EXTEND

Was Pearl Harbor the **cause** of U.S. entry, or the **final push**? Defend your answer with the two-theater pressures.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **map** the two theaters that drew America in.

Who Led World War II?

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

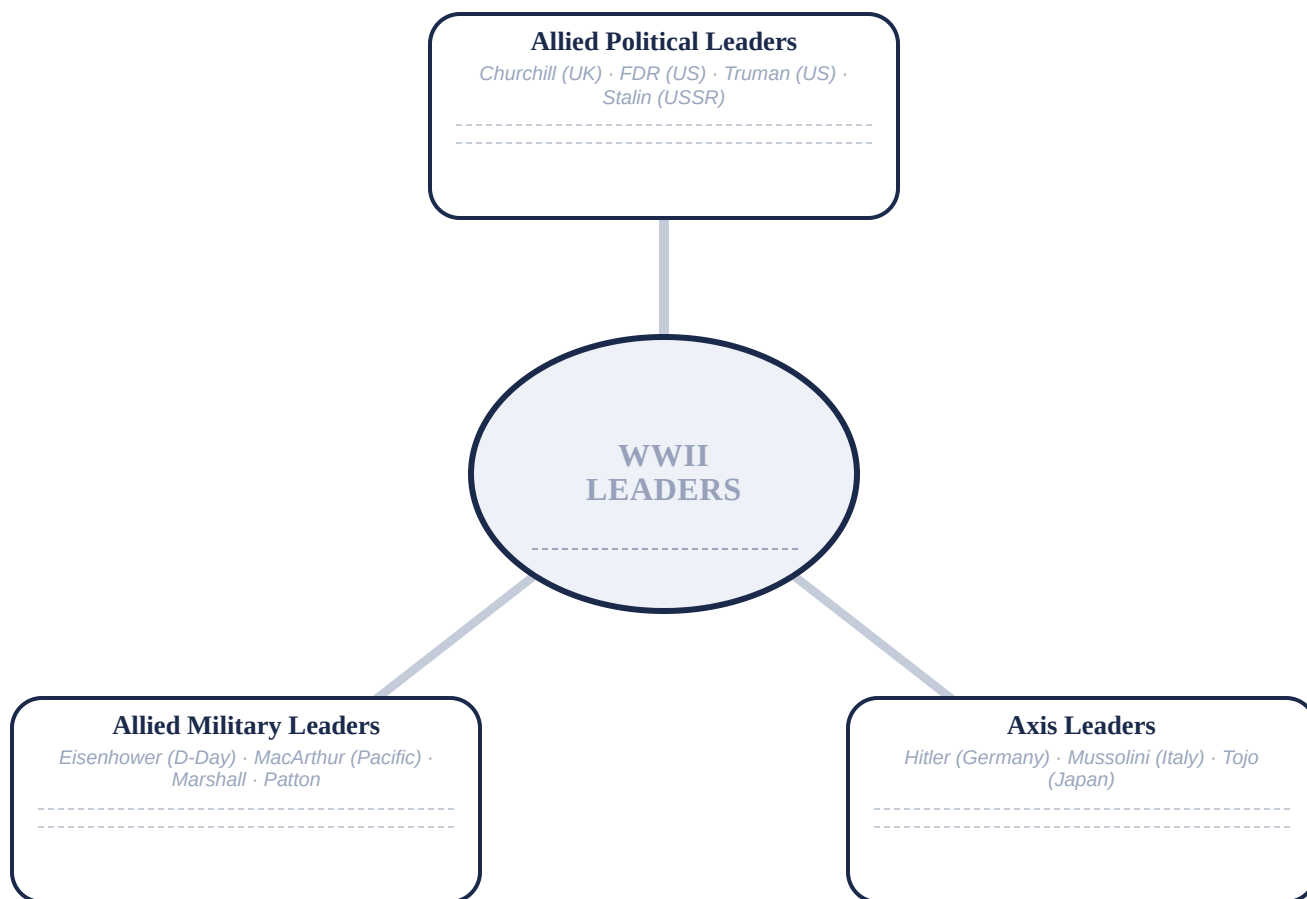
Concept Web

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 1-2 • Identify

WHEN • WHY A web sorts the war's many leaders into three families around one hub — so students see at a glance who fought on which side, and can attach each one's role. *Organizing people and roles into one picture builds SSP.01 (collect information).*

The hub is the war's leadership. Sort each figure into the right bubble, then write each one's role or key action over the faint names — who led, and what they did.



★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee helped supply the war's leadership: Lt. Alexander "Sandy" Ninninger trained at **Fort Oglethorpe near Chattanooga** and was the **first Medal of Honor recipient of WWII**, and thousands of officers trained at Tennessee installations before deploying to both theaters.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the figures on cards; sort them into the three bubbles together before writing roles.

EXTEND

Which leader's decisions mattered most to the war's outcome? Defend your pick with a key action.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** roles, **say** them aloud, or **match** figure cards to actions.

WHEN · WHY A matrix holds four battles against one yardstick, so students see how **geography and military factors** shaped each outcome across the Pacific and European theaters. *Comparing on structured criteria is Marzano's highest-yield strategy; SSP.03 synthesize.*

Compare the four battles across the same three questions. The faint notes are starters — write over them, then look for the pattern: how geography and military factors shaped each outcome.

BATTLE → COMPARE ↓	Midway Pacific	Iwo Jima Pacific	Okinawa Pacific	D-Day Europe
When & where	June 1942 · central Pacific atoll	Feb.–Mar. 1945 · volcanic island	Apr.–June 1945 · 340 mi. from Japan	June 6, 1944 · Normandy, France
Key geographic / military factor	U.S. codebreakers revealed Japan's plan; carriers ambushed the fleet	volcanic terrain & tunnels; airfields needed for B-29 bombers	close to Japan — a staging base for an invasion	largest amphibious invasion ever; Eisenhower in command
Outcome & why it mattered	4 Japanese carriers sunk — the Pacific turning point	costly Marine victory; iconic flag on Mt. Suribachi	bloodiest Pacific battle — showed the cost of invading Japan	opened the Western Front; freed France; squeezed Germany

★ **Tennessee Connection** — Tennesseans served in every major battle of WWII. The **30th Infantry Division**, with Tennessee soldiers, fought from Normandy to the Elbe, and **Camp Forrest** near Tullahoma trained troops who fought at Normandy, Iwo Jima, and across the Pacific.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Fill the **When & where** row together first, then let students complete each battle by column.

EXTEND
Which mattered more to each outcome — **geography** or a **military decision**?
Defend your answer for one battle.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write** in cells, **say** a column aloud, or **map** the four battle sites.

They Fought for a Country That Doubted Them

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN · WHY A main-idea organizer separates the **big idea** from the units that support it, so students summarize the meaning of these forces' service instead of just listing them. *Summarizing — keep the main idea, cut the rest — is a high-yield comprehension strategy (Marzano).*

Fill each detail box first, using the faint hints as anchors. Then infer the main idea all four units support and write it up top — the arrows show every detail holding it up. Finish with one summary sentence.

MAIN IDEA			
Special forces and individual soldiers — many facing prejudice at home — made decisive contributions and sacrifices to win the war.			

↑ THESE FOUR FORCES SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA ↑

Tuskegee Airmen	442nd Combat Team	101st Airborne	Navajo Code Talkers
First African American military pilots; 332nd Fighter Group; 15,000+ sorties; helped lead to 1948 desegregation of the military.	Japanese American volunteers — many with families interned; most decorated unit of its size; 21 Medals of Honor; "Go for Broke."	"Screaming Eagles" parachuted into Normandy on D-Day; secured bridges; defended Bastogne in the Battle of the Bulge.	Used the Navajo language as an unbreakable battlefield code in the Pacific — never cracked by the enemy.

In one sentence, what did these forces show about who won the war?

★ **Tennessee Connection — Fort Campbell**, straddling the Tennessee–Kentucky border, became home to the **101st Airborne Division** ("Screaming Eagles") — whose paratroopers jumped into Normandy on D-Day and fought through the Battle of the Bulge.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS		
SCAFFOLD Fill the four detail boxes first using the faint hints, then infer the main idea together. Frame: "All four of these show that ____."	EXTEND Several of these units served while facing prejudice at home. What does that add to their story? Defend your answer with evidence.	SHOW IT YOUR WAY Students may write the boxes, say the main idea aloud, or present one unit's story.

When the Nation Needed Them: Women in WWII

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY Reading it as **need** → **women step in** → **impact** shows how a labor shortage opened doors — and how the gains came alongside real limits that outlasted the war. *Analyzing cause & effect is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

The wartime labor shortage sits on the left; four effects — gains and limits — flow out on the right. Arrows show the chain: **need** → **women step in** → **impact**.

CAUSES • WHY WOMEN WERE NEEDED

16 million men in the armed forces → a massive labor shortage

War production had to double the manufacturing workforce

“Rosie the Riveter” campaigns + economic necessity recruited women

THE CHANGE

WOMEN ENTER THE WORKFORCE & ARMED FORCES

12M (1940) → 20M (1945); 36% of civilian workers; 65% of aircraft workers. Describe the shift

EFFECTS • GAINS & LIMITS

Built bombers, Liberty ships & ammunition — record production

Gained independence, technical skills & military roles (WAC, WAVES)

But faced lower pay (~65% of men's), scarce childcare & criticism

Shifted expectations — setting the stage for later change

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee women entered the workforce in unprecedented numbers. At **Oak Ridge**, women made up a large share of the workforce — many operating **calutrons to enrich uranium** without knowing the full nature of their work — while others served in the WAC, WAVES, and as nurses overseas.

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SCAFFOLD

Fill the center change box first. Then sort the right-side boxes into **gains** and **limits**.

EXTEND

Did WWII **permanently** change women's place in the workforce, or was it temporary? Use the effects to argue.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **diagram** how wartime need reshaped women's work.

Victory Abroad, the Fight at Home

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

✓ REPRODUCIBLE

⌚ 15-20 min

Main Idea & Details

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2-3 · Summarize

WHEN · WHY A main-idea organizer separates the **big idea** from the developments that support it, so students see how wartime change fed the coming civil rights movement. *Summarizing — keep the main idea, cut the rest — is a high-yield comprehension strategy (Marzano).*

Fill each detail box first, using the faint hints as anchors. Then infer the main idea all four support and write it up top — the arrows show every detail holding it up. Finish with one summary sentence.

MAIN IDEA

WWII opened new jobs and raised civil-rights consciousness for African Americans — laying groundwork for the postwar movement.

↑ THESE FOUR DEVELOPMENTS SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA ↑

Migration & Jobs

1.5M moved North & West (Detroit, Chicago, LA) for defense jobs; Black family income doubled — but discrimination persisted.

Double V Campaign

The Pittsburgh Courier called for victory over fascism **abroad** and racism **at home**; NAACP grew from 50,000 to 450,000.

Military Service

1 million served in segregated forces — fighting for democracy while facing prejudice, sharpening the contradiction.

FEPC (EO 8802)

A. Philip Randolph's threatened march pressured FDR to issue Executive Order 8802 (1941), creating the FEPC against job discrimination.

In one sentence, how did WWII move civil rights forward?

★ **Tennessee Connection** — African Americans in Tennessee contributed greatly despite segregation; the **FEPC** reached Tennessee war industries, and after the war **returning Black veterans** became leaders in Tennessee's civil rights movement.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill the four detail boxes first using the faint hints, then infer the main idea together.
Frame: "All four of these show that ____."

EXTEND

How did the **Double V** idea connect the war abroad to the fight at home? Defend your answer with evidence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** the boxes, **say** the main idea aloud, or **design** a Double V poster.

Security vs. the Constitution: Japanese American Internment

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY Internment forced a clash between wartime security and constitutional rights. A T-chart lays the government's case beside the constitutional objection on the same lenses, so students judge from evidence. *Constructing and communicating an argument from evidence is a TN Social Studies Practice (SSP.04).*

Weigh the government's justification against the constitutional objection on the same three lenses. Gather evidence in each light box — then take your own position on the line at the bottom.

	THE GOVERNMENT'S CASE wartime security	THE CONSTITUTIONAL OBJECTION civil liberties
The Order what happened?	EO 9066 (Feb. 1942) removed ~120,000 from "military areas"	two-thirds were U.S. citizens ; no hearings or evidence of disloyalty
The Rationale why?	"military necessity" — fear of espionage after Pearl Harbor	no such detention of German/Italian Americans → a racial basis
Korematsu (1944) the ruling	the Supreme Court upheld the order 6–3 as wartime necessity	dissenters: racial discrimination; detention without charges

The principles at stake: internment raised questions of **due process** (no individual hearings), **equal protection** (a race-based policy), and **habeas corpus** (detention without charges) — the core protections the Constitution is meant to guarantee even in wartime.

Your verdict — When national security and civil liberties collide, which should win — and who decides? _____ **because** _____

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SCAFFOLD

Define **due process**, **equal protection**, and **habeas corpus** first. Fill the "Order" row together.

EXTEND

The Court sided with the government in 1944. Using the objection column, argue how a court might rule differently today.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** their cells, **say** a position aloud, or hold a structured **debate** before writing.

Winning the War at Home

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

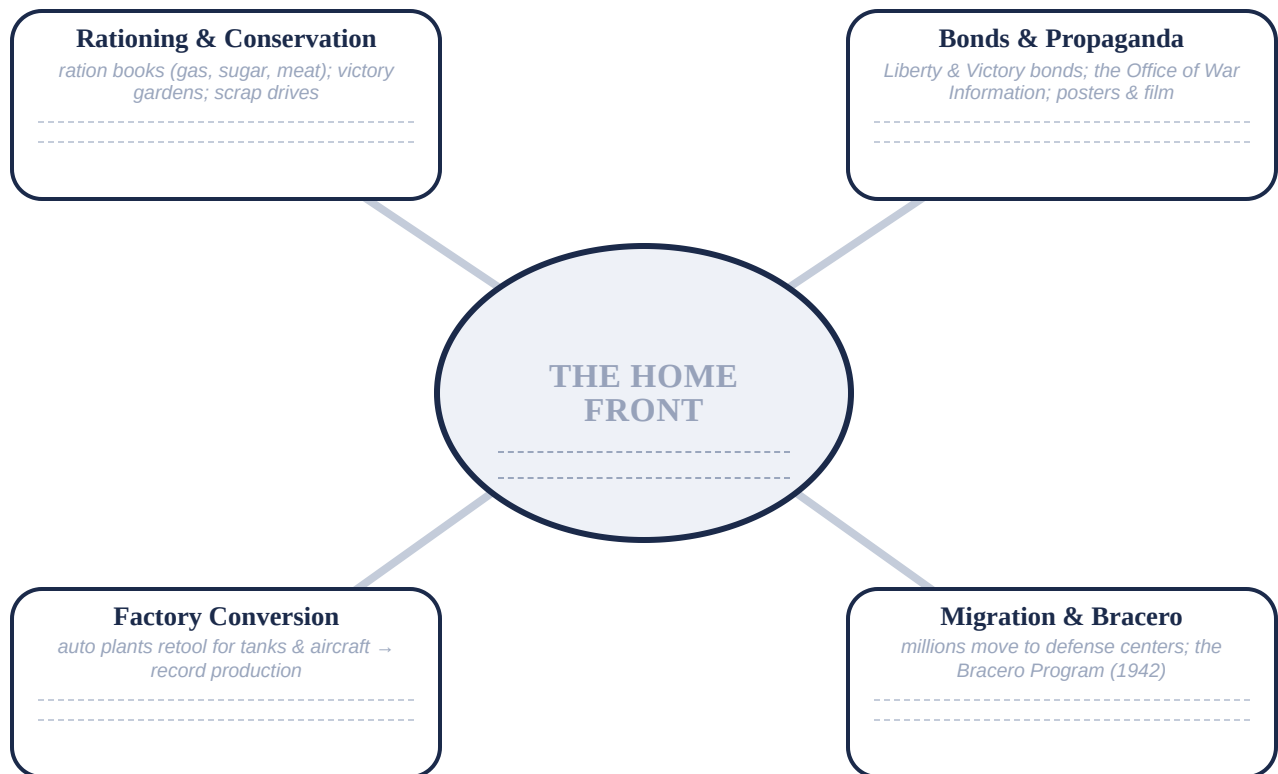
Concept Web

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2 • Describe

WHEN • WHY A web shows rationing, bonds, factory conversion, and labor as one home-front system feeding the war effort — and how each part connects to victory. *Connecting ideas around one hub builds SSP.01 (collect information).*

The hub is the war at home. On each bubble, write how that effort supported the war — the faint notes are starters. Then answer the box below: how did the home front make victory possible?



How did civilians far from the fighting help win the war?

shared sacrifice built national unity • factories out-produced the enemy • bonds & labor kept the war supplied

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee was a major center for war production: **Alcoa, Tennessee**, produced **aluminum for military aircraft**, and **Camp Forrest** near Tullahoma was a major Army training base, as women across the state joined the workforce in unprecedented numbers.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the four bubble labels as a word bank; fill one together. Ask: which effort touched the most families?

EXTEND

Draw links **between** bubbles — e.g., how did propaganda connect to bond drives and to factory work?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **design** a home-front poster for one bubble.

The Secret City & the Bomb That Ended the War

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY Reading it as **project** → **bomb** → **surrender** lets students explain the rationale for using the atomic bomb while weighing its cost — and see Tennessee's central role. *Analyzing cause & effect and weighing a decision are TN Social Studies Practices (SSP.05, SSP.04).*

The secret project sits on the left; the outcomes and the rationale flow out on the right. Arrows show the chain: **project** → **the bomb** → **the war ends**. Then weigh the decision.

CAUSES • THE MANHATTAN PROJECT

Oak Ridge, TN — the “Secret City”: TVA power & secrecy enrich uranium

A secret multi-site program: Los Alamos, Oak Ridge & Hanford; Groves & Oppenheimer

The Trinity test (**July 16, 1945**) proves the bomb works

THE EVENT

THE ATOMIC BOMB Hiroshima & Nagasaki, **Aug. 1945**

Truman authorized the bomb to end the war quickly — describe the decision

EFFECTS • OUTCOME & RATIONALE

Japan surrenders — World War II ends

Rationale: avoid a costly invasion (feared huge casualties)

Rationale: force a rapid surrender; signal U.S. power to the USSR

The atomic age begins — opening the Cold War

The decision, then and now. The bombings ended the war but caused enormous civilian loss of life, and historians still **debate** whether they were necessary. A good answer explains the rationale *and* weighs the cost.

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Oak Ridge, Tennessee — the “Secret City” — was a central Manhattan Project site. Built from scratch in 1942 and shown on **no maps**, it employed over **75,000 workers** enriching the uranium for the bomb, making Tennessee crucial to the atomic age.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill the center box first. Then sort the right side into **what happened** vs. the **reasons given**.

EXTEND

Weigh it: explain the rationale for the bomb, then give the strongest reason someone might disagree.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **diagram** the project-to-surrender chain.

Yalta & Potsdam: Two Meetings, One Widening Split

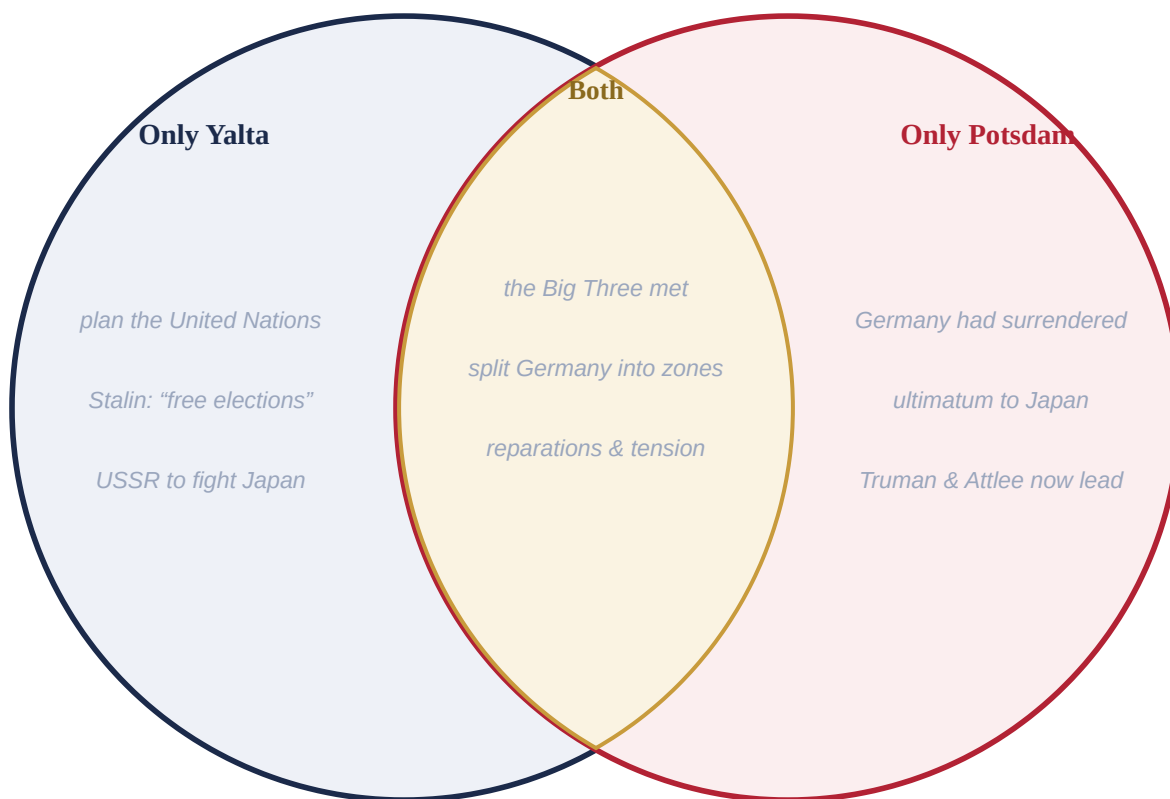
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN · WHY Two conferences, months apart, decided the shape of the post-war world. A Venn makes the **overlap** visible — and sharpens what changed between February and July 1945. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's highest-yield strategy; SSP.03.*

Both were Allied conferences near the war's end. Write what was unique to each on its side, and what they shared in the middle — the faint notes are starters.

YALTA · Feb. 1945 — FDR · Churchill · Stalin

POTSDAM · July–Aug. 1945 — Truman · Attlee · Stalin



Why it matters → Both conferences exposed a growing split: Stalin's "free elections" meant communist-controlled governments, while the West expected real democracy — the **origins of the Cold War**.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill the **Both** region first (they were both Allied conferences), then find what made each one different.

EXTEND

What changed between Yalta and Potsdam — in leaders, and in trust? Explain what the shift reveals.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **sort** outcome cards into the three regions.

Building a Body to Keep the Peace

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

⌚ 15-20 min

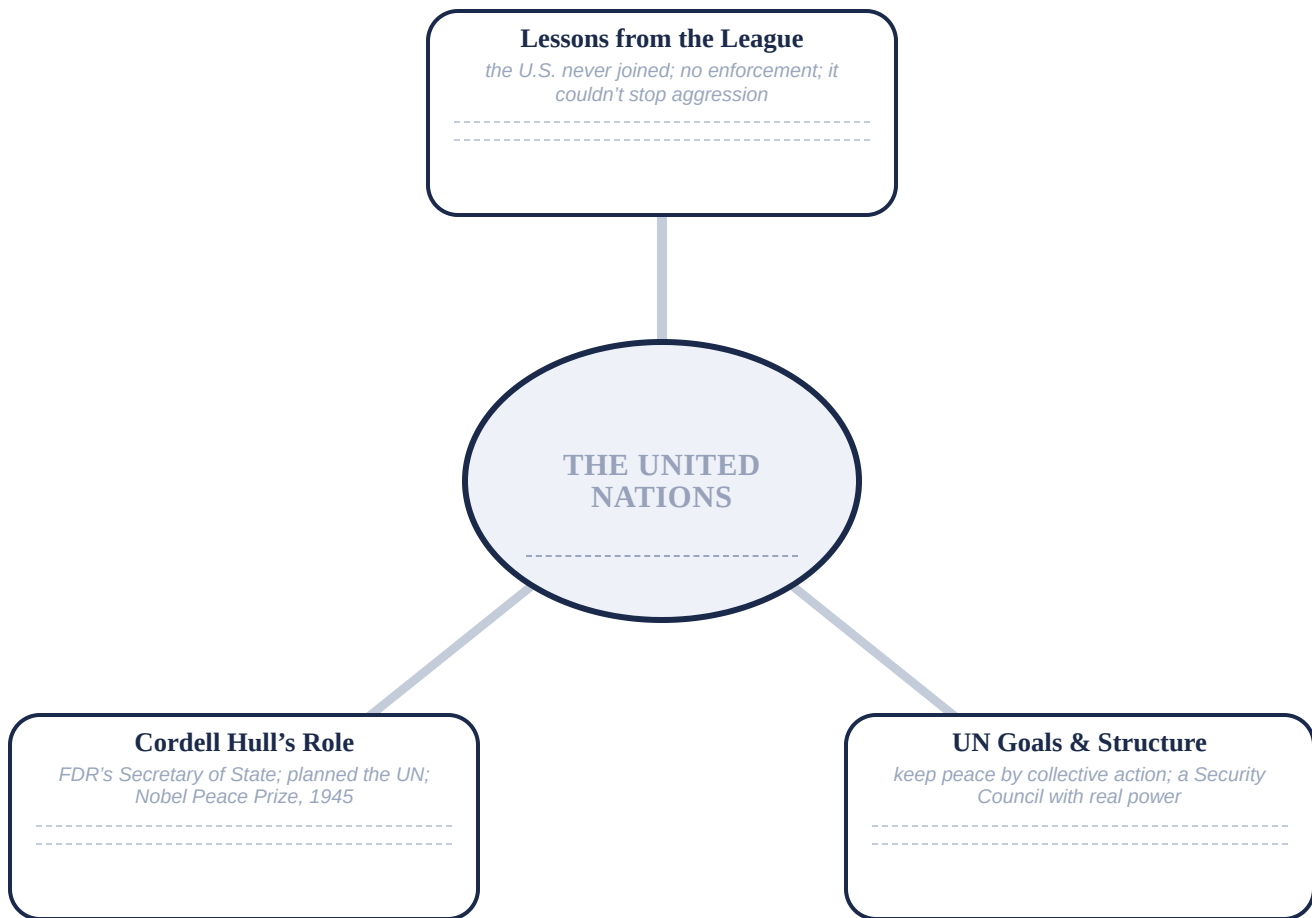
Concept Web

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2 • Cause & Purpose

WHEN • WHY A web connects **why** the UN was founded — the League's failure, a Tennessean's leadership, and the goals it was built to serve — around one hub. *Connecting causes and purpose into one picture builds SSP.05.*

The hub is the new organization. On each bubble, write how it shaped the UN — the faint notes are starters. The League failed; planners built the UN to fix those weaknesses.



★ **Tennessee Connection.** Cordell Hull of Pickett County, Tennessee, served as Secretary of State (1933–1944) and was instrumental in founding the United Nations — earning the **Nobel Peace Prize in 1945** and the title “Father of the United Nations,” one of Tennessee's greatest contributions to world history.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Start with the League bubble: list why it failed, then show how each UN feature answers a failure.

EXTEND

Which weakness of the League was most important to fix? Defend your pick using the UN's structure.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **match** each League failure to its UN fix.